

Companion to the core pitch document. This document details Crunda's market fit, its current Steam wishlist data and visibility for the game.

Core claim: Crunda does well when it is shown to an audience, but as a solo dev I have done a poor job of showing it.

AI Disclosure: Claude was used in the analysis of Steam and market data and document construction. All figures were verified against the primary sources.

Crunda aims to sit within a lineage of short games built on **one physically satisfying mechanic**. Its closest comparisons come from high-skill-ceiling movement games. For this analysis I have chosen to look at *Clustertruck* and *Neon White* on that basis, but also *Pikuniku*, which is a closer tone and price comparison.

All these titles landed mid-band or better commercially and **every one of them had a publisher, a viral moment, or both**. None succeeded on organic discovery alone.

Title	Year	Price	Team	Owners (est.)	Revenue (est., gross)	Publisher · breakout moment
Clustertruck	2016	\$14.99	trio	1–2M	~909K units / ~\$8.8M	tinyBuild · multi-episode launch series from jacksepticeye and peers; built-in Twitch chat integration
Neon White	2022	\$24.99	small	200–500K+	~619K units / ~\$10.7M	Annapurna · critical acclaim + speedrun-community word of mouth
Pikuniku	2019	\$10.99	4	500K–1M · inflated by giveaways	~116K paid units / ~\$0.9M	Devolver · showcase marketing + Epic Games Store free-week giveaway

*Method: third-party estimates (VG Insights, Aug 2026; SteamSpy owner ranges), Steam gross only, order-of-magnitude as estimators disagree by up to 10×.¹ The solo floor for this class ([Islets](#), [Minit](#), [A Monster's Expedition](#)) is roughly \$1M Steam gross each, before console and mobile ports. The breakouts - *Celeste*, *Baba Is You*, *Animal Well* - are excluded from the table as outliers.*

Crunda's price at \$12.99 sits deliberately in the *Pikuniku* / *Clustertruck* band, below the \$19.99–24.99 short-form premium tier (*Inside*, *Cocoon*, *Neon White*) aiding conversion and setting expectations for a 3–5 hour game.

Within Collective's own catalogue, Crunda touches two reference points:

- **Circuit Superstars' replay depth** - time attack, ghosts, leaderboards, simple inputs with a high ceiling.
- **PowerWash Simulator's** inherently satisfying, inherently clippable physical process.

THREE PROJECTIONS

Indie platformers are one of the easiest genres to produce, and so the market is filled with titles that sell almost no copies, a core that sells reasonably, and a handful that dominate the market. Below are three revenue projections based on these categories. The core document argues Crunda is original - its mechanics and visuals make it instantly stand out - and *Section 3* shows audiences respond every time the game is shown.

Scenario	Copies (first year)	Gross	What puts a game here
Sinks - launch to silence	<2,000 (typically a few hundred)	<\$20k	The most common outcome: the median Steam release grosses ~\$1k lifetime, and over half of all Steam games never clear \$1,000. ⁴ Games land here when audiences don't respond on contact. The exposure record argues against this bucket - every showing to date has drawn a response (Sections 3 and 6) - though only a marketed launch can settle it.
Lands - marketed launch, no viral moment	3,000–20,000	\$25–175k	Assumes publisher marketing closes the gap from today's 949 wishlists to a 7–20k launch (see <i>Section 4</i>). Basis: 7–20k launch wishlists × 0.2 first-week sales per wishlist × 2–5× first-year multiple, at ~\$8.75 realized per copy (~67% of list, derived from the comparison titles). ⁵ The upper half of this band repays the £50–60k budget in year one; the central case repays it over the tail.
Breaks out - the comparisons table above	100K+	\$1M+	A creator moment or viral word-of-mouth - this can't be constructed, only planned for. Every game in the comparisons table had a publisher, a viral moment, or both; the table spans ~116K–909K units and ~\$0.9M–10.7M gross.

Figures are Steam gross in USD; roughly 55–58% reaches the developer after Steam's cut, VAT and refunds.⁵ The middle row is the case this document argues for; the bottom row is what the evidence in *Section 3* argues against; the top row is why the bet is asymmetric.

NEXT FEST TICKET WAS WASTED

Valve allows one Next Fest per game, and the published guidance is not to enter below ~2,000 wishlists. In Zukowski's benchmarks, no game entering under 1,000 broke out of its tier.² I entered at roughly 350 and came out at ~630. Why did I enter? Because I genuinely believed the game was almost done - a huge miscalculation, and a classic solo-developer scoping error. This mistake would not have happened with a publisher there to advise - I would have been told to wait on both counts. That estimate was also made before any act had gone from script to shipped build, the current timeline in the Core document is extrapolated from progress on the demo and Act 1.

THE STEAM DATA SHOWS CRUNDA SITS AT 949 NET WISHLISTS AFTER 21 MONTHS WHICH IS A WEAK NUMBER

No framing changes that. The claim is not that the number is good - it's that the number is **uninformative**: every exposure performed well - three at scale with measured conversion rates, two in person with jury selection and players competing at the stand (Section 6) - and the number simply records how rarely exposure happened.

The wishlist curve tracks promotional activity directly. Crunda's Steam page went live in November 2024.

Since then Crunda has reached an audience at scale **three times** - a video I made aimed at developers, a third party article and Steam Next Fest - and each produced a wishlist spike at a measured rate of 0.4–0.9%.

Two further in-person festival showings were validation events: audiences too small to read conversion from, but jury-selected entry and the strongest direct evidence the game works on contact (Section 6).

When	Event	Audience	Reach	Net adds	Rate
Dec 2024 – Jan 2025	Physics video (self-made)	developers	~50,000 views	~222	0.44% / view
Feb – Mar 2025	Steam Next Fest	consumers, cold browse	80,989 impressions	~297	0.37% / impression
Mar 2025	Third-party coverage (Alpha Beta Gamer)	players	~11,000 footage views	~99	0.9% / view
Aug 2025	Glasgow Independent Games Festival	consumers, in person	festival attendees	~12	-
Jul 2026	Develop:Brighton	industry	~2,000 attendees	~63	-

Impressions attributed by time-window.³ The two festival rows are validation rather than conversion evidence.

Net wishlists stand at 949 (August 2026). 78% of lifetime adds landed in the first five months - the period covering all three at-scale exposures. The quiet months in between produced under 80 net.

The obvious question - a page live for twenty-one months, why hasn't it grown organically? This has an answer:

it grew every time it reached an audience at scale - in a video, an article, and a Steam event entered too early. Between those, it adds six a month. The mechanic has never been put in front of the people who would buy it.

THIRD-PARTY COVERAGE CONVERTS ROUGHLY TWICE AS WELL AS SELF-PROMOTION

[Alpha Beta Gamer's coverage](#) - an article with gameplay footage attached - had 22% of the visible reach of my own video (~11k footage views against ~50k) and produced 45% as many wishlists: ~0.9% per view against ~0.44%. The coverage was unsolicited, closed with "*highly recommended*", and linked the demo directly. (Note the article's readership beyond the embedded footage isn't visible to me, but the piece is footage-led, so views are a fair proxy.)

But the direction matches the industry pattern: someone else playing your game is an endorsement, you presenting it is an ad. Getting a game into creators' hands is something that I hope you can help with. My video addressed developers, Brighton addressed industry. The only direct-to-player self-promotion ever attempted is a single TikTok clip (February 2025): posted from a cold account with no following, it reached ~2,000 viewers organically and drew comments, but the channel was never posted to again and the wishlists around it were flat. Beyond that, Next Fest and Glasgow were the only true consumer exposure, and Next Fest happened at 350 wishlists with the same capsule art still on the page today. The storefront converts at **0.78% on cold browse against 8.7% on search and 13.6% on curator recommendation.**³ When someone arrives with intent, the page converts; the first impression is the weak link - a capsule/key art commission is already a line in the core pitch deck's budget.

WHO THE AUDIENCE IS, CONCRETELY

A campaign has three natural channels, in order of evidence:

- **Creators adjacent to the comparisons** - the Celeste / Neon White / Clustertruck coverage ecosystem, where one unsolicited pickup already converted at 2× self-promotion
- **The speedrun and time-attack community** - ghosts, medals and global leaderboards are already in the demo, giving runners something to compete on from day one
- **Short-form clip channels** - the wobble reads in three seconds of footage with no context, the same property a marketing partner monetised with *PowerWash Simulator*. (A single TikTok test in Feb 2025 reached ~2,000 organic views from a cold account - a hint the format travels, but too small to call evidence.)

Yet these people have not yet been directly approached.

The Collective has a stated interest in projects that "grow beyond one release" or "evolve for an online audience". Leaderboards and ghost racing are built and in the current demo. The medal structure gives every level a competitive afterlife without live-service infrastructure (three inputs, deterministic levels, and seeded randomness).

NEAR-TERM, LOW-COST

Level packs are the natural DLC unit. The medal/ghost structure absorbs new levels without redesign, and the same editor that builds the main game builds the packs.

HOW MUCH TO INVEST ON COMMUNITY TOOLING?

The in-game level editor exists in the codebase - it is the tool the game is built with. Shipping it to players is a nontrivial amount of work: hiding internals, and building UX for workflows that currently run through the in-game console. As a solo dev I want to prioritise effort to the critical path for release. So the plan for the editor is to ship as a post-launch update - which is also when it's worth the most, landing as a re-engagement beat into an existing community.

I am open to discussions on how much to invest here. At a minimum file-based level sharing is possible, a full online service with uploading, browsing, favouriting could be discussed and scoped together. Community levels for a speedrun game are a credible long-tail that keeps people engaged.

PROJECTS AFTER CRUNDA

Road Toads - *Frogger* turned into a competitive couch co-op experience. An existing prototype that has been played to death in private sessions, but not been taken to public events. This also has a Steam page and a demo available. When deciding a project to work on both Road Toads and Crunda were options but Crunda had a more proven track record.

As an investment, I believe Crunda has a limited downside and a high upside. One developer, a systems-built game, requiring guidance and a £50–60k budget - self-funded if need be - to reach a finished PC release.

- **Develop:Brighton 2026 Indie Showcase Finalist** - 1 of 10 selected nationally, jury-selected, judged on innovation and originality.
- **At the stand, players understood the game immediately and needed no instruction** and the competitive loop proved itself unprompted. On day two a physical high-score board went up and players got intensely competitive. When chasing a visible time, people replayed the same levels again and again; several played for 40 minutes straight - standing, in a crowded room, during a heatwave - and one attendee came back the next day to play again. However, medals alone didn't drive retries unless players were guided to them - **visible, social competition did**. That is what I can build into the shipping game with time tracking and ghosts from friends.
- **Ludum Dare 2021 - 1st place, "Fun" and 3rd overall** of ~3,000 entries - the original prototype; the mechanic was the most-fun thing in the field on first contact.
- **Glasgow Independent Games Festival 2025** - exhibited.
- **Demo (Steam, Aug 2026 snapshot):** 581 lifetime users; median playtime 9 minutes, 47% past the 10-minute mark. Most of those users arrived in Feb–Mar 2025, when the demo ran roughly 10–15 minutes at home - [Alpha Beta Gamer's contemporaneous review](#) calls it "about 10 minutes" - so the median cold-arriving player got through most of the demo they were given. However, the demo length wasn't version-tracked, so the numbers here are imprecise. The current 12-level build typically runs 10–20 minutes at a booth, with an observed range of about 7–30 minutes: newcomers spend their first 5–10 minutes learning the controls before playing in earnest, but experienced platformer players were able to pick it up right away. Downloads skew 45% North America / 31% Western Europe. Happy to share raw export data.

1. Comparable estimates: [VG Insights](#) per-title pages (linked in the Section 1 table), accessed August 2026; cross-checked against [SteamSpy](#) owner ranges. Steam-only, gross. ↩
2. Next Fest wishlist benchmarks: Chris Zukowski, ["Benchmarks: How Many Wishlists Can I Get From Steam Next Fest"](#), [HowToMarketAGame](#). ↩
3. First-party Steamworks exports — wishlists, storefront traffic and conversion, demo playtime and regions. Raw exports available on request. ↩
4. Median-outcome data: Chris Zukowski, ["The median indie game does not earn a whole lot"](#) (median 2019 release: ~\$1,136 lifetime gross); GameDiscoverCo, ["Most PC games gross <\\$1,000"](#). ↩
5. Wishlist-to-sales multiples: GameDiscoverCo, ["Steam: the new wishlists to first week sales expectations"](#) (median 0.2 first-week sales per launch wishlist; first year = 2–5× first week); launch-wishlist floor: Zukowski, ["How many wishlists should I have when I launch my game?"](#) (~7,000 for Popular Upcoming). Gross-to-net: GameDiscoverCo, ["Game refunds & the hidden costs of getting to net on Steam"](#). ↩